

picked out in alternating red and white. The mosque is reached via a stately, arcaded courtyard.

Villa Farnese

Location Caprarola, Italy

The Villa Farnese was originally planned as a fortress, but only its five-sided foundations were constructed. In 1556, it was decided instead to build an imposing villa on those foundations. The result,

designed by Giacomo da Vignola, is among the largest and most important Italian villas of the 16th century. It is a monumental and supremely confident building. Its base is heavily rusticated; its two, many-windowed upper stories are symmetrical and precise; and it is capped by a boldly projecting cornice. At the villa's heart lies a circular courtyard formed by pairs of Ionic columns. Perhaps its most striking features are the theatrical

▼ CIRCULAR STAIRCASE WITH DOUBLE COLUMNS IN THE VILLA FARNESE

stairways that lead to the building. The first, curving pair give way to two further flights that dramatically double back on each other.

Town Hall, Antwerp

Location Antwerp, Belgium

As the influence of the Renaissance spread across Europe in the 16th century, at least initially, Classicism was frequently adopted alongside existing architectural styles.

Antwerp's town hall, completed in 1564, is an excellent example of the resulting hybrid—Flemish fused with Classical. Set on a rusticated base, it features nine bays on each side of three central bays that project slightly forward. Each of the central section's five stories, which burst through the roof-line, is conceived as a series of triumphal arches: three on the first two floors, two on the third, and one each on the final two. The upper floor is crowned by a pedimented gable. Slim obelisks rise from each side of the third level.

